The Ark

AI for Everyone, Paid with Lightning

arknode.ai

Baobab Network Accelerator Application — March 2026

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The Problem

2 billion people are locked out of AI.

$20
ChatGPT monthly cost — more than many Africans earn per day

57%
of Africans have no bank account or credit card

0
AI platforms accept Bitcoin Lightning payments

AI is becoming the world's most important tool — but the people who need it most can't access it.

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The Solution

Pay-per-task AI. Bitcoin Lightning. Starting at $0.01.

No subscriptions. No credit cards. No KYC.

Just AI, on demand, for anyone with a Lightning wallet.

120+ AI services in one platform. ChatGPT-style interface. Instant Lightning payments.

💻

Development

Code review, bug finder, unit tests, Dockerfile gen, CI/CD, security scan, regex, SQL optimization

📝

Content

Blog posts, SEO analysis, ad copy, social posts, email drafts, grammar check, rewriting, translation

⚖️

Professional

Legal drafts, contracts, privacy policies, NDAs, medical summaries, financial reports, business plans

🎨 Creative

Voice generation, image creation, voice narration, African TTS, image editing

📊 Data & Analysis

CSV/JSON processing, PDF extraction, data visualization, spreadsheet analysis, research

🤖 AI Agents

Agent design, LangChain gen, multi-agent systems, prompt engineering, agent debugging

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How It Works

1️⃣

Choose a Task

Pick from 120+ services or just type what you need in the chat interface

2️⃣

Pay with Lightning

Scan a QR code or pay from your wallet. Tasks cost 10–8,000 sats ($0.01–$8)

3️⃣

Get Results

AI processes your request instantly. Streamed in real-time. Done in seconds.

🤖 Machine-to-Machine (L402)

Other AI agents and apps can programmatically pay for and consume our services via the L402 protocol — no human in the loop needed.

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Market Opportunity

$85B

Global AI-as-a-Service by 2030

$2.7B

Africa AI market (2025), growing 35% CAGR

Our Addressable Market

- ⚡ **1.4 billion** people in Africa — world's youngest continent
- ⚡ **2+ billion** unbanked globally who can't access existing AI tools
- ⚡ **6M+ Lightning users** and growing rapidly
- ⚡ **700M+ smartphone users** in Africa by 2030

Africa has the world's youngest population and fastest-growing smartphone adoption. The demand for AI tools is massive — the access isn't.

Traction — 3 Weeks In

120+
Production AI services

11
Users (pre-marketing)

6
Workflow bundles

90%+
Profit margins

What we built in 3 weeks (bootstrapped, $1K):

- ⚡ Full ChatGPT-style web interface with real-time streaming
- ⚡ 120+ AI services across 12 categories
- ⚡ Bitcoin Lightning payment system (mainnet, real money)
- ⚡ Wallet system for returning users
- ⚡ L402 machine-to-machine protocol
- ⚡ OpenAPI spec + developer documentation
- ⚡ Automated social media (Nostr bot, Telegram channel)

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Business Model

Pay-Per-Task Pricing

Tier	Price	Examples
Basic	**10 sats (~$0.01)**	Summarize, translate, research
Standard	**20-100 sats**	Code review, SEO, unit tests
Professional	**200-500 sats**	Legal drafts, business plans
Premium	**3,000-8,000 sats**	Voice gen, image creation

Unit Economics

AI cost per task: <1 sat ($0.0001)
Average task price: 50 sats ($0.05)
Gross margin: 90%+

Why so cheap? We migrated from OpenAI ($15/M tokens) to open-source Qwen 2.5 ($0.23/M tokens) — a 95% cost reduction.

Revenue Streams

- Per-task payments
- Day passes (1,000 sats)
- Workflow bundles (1,200-5,000 sats)
- Future: marketplace commission

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Competitive Advantage

FEATURE	THE ARK	CHATGPT	JASPER/COPY.AI
Pay-per-task (no subscription)	✅	❌	❌
Bitcoin Lightning payments	✅	❌	❌
No KYC / no account required	✅	❌	❌
120+ service categories	✅	✅	❌
Machine-to-machine (L402)	✅	❌	❌
Workflow bundles	✅	❌	❌
Africa-first pricing	✅	❌	❌
Cost per basic task	**$0.01**	$0.67/task*	$1.63/task*

* Based on monthly subscription ÷ average tasks per user

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Founder & CEO

The Ark

AI-Augmented Development

Our Unfair Advantage

We used AI to build an AI company. One founder built what traditionally requires a team of 5-10 — in 3 weeks. This is proof of our thesis: AI makes a single determined founder as powerful as a full team.

Why This Team Wins

- ⚡ Deep understanding of African payment challenges — lived experience
- ⚡ Built and shipped a production AI platform with real payments in weeks, not months
- ⚡ Expertise in Bitcoin Lightning infrastructure (Phoenixd, LNbits, L402)
- ⚡ Speed of execution: 120+ services, live payments, automated marketing — all bootstrapped

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Use of $100K Investment

$30K
Marketing & Growth
African markets, Bitcoin communities, dev conferences, content marketing

$25K
Engineering
Hire 1-2 developers, mobile app, local language support, API expansion

$20K
AI Infrastructure
Scale compute, add models, reduce latency, self-host capability

$15K
Business Dev
Wallet partnerships, fintech integrations, African tech hub presence

$10K
Operations
Incorporation, legal, accounting, 6-month buffer

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12-Month Roadmap

- **Month 3 — Launch**
  1,000 users · $500/mo revenue · Marketing live across Africa
- **Month 6 — Growth**
  5,000 users · $2K/mo · Mobile app · 3 Lightning wallet partnerships
- **Month 9 — Expansion**
  15,000 users · $5K/mo · 5 African languages · M-Pesa integration
- **Month 12 — Scale**
  50,000 users · $10K/mo · Third-party marketplace live · Profitable
- **Month 18 — Dominate**
  100,000+ users · $25K/mo · The default AI utility for emerging markets

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THE VISION

AI for the Next Billion.

The Ark is bringing AI access to billions of people who are currently locked out by payment barriers.

We're raising

$100,000

to reach product-market fit in 12 months

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